

Dislocation



Joint dislocation (Latin: luxatio) [1] occurs when bones in a joint become displaced or misaligned. It is often caused by a sudden impact to the joint.

The ligaments always become damaged as a result of a dislocation.

A subluxation is a partial dislocation



Dislocation

There are some medical conditions by where joint dislocations are frequent and spontaneous,

Sites

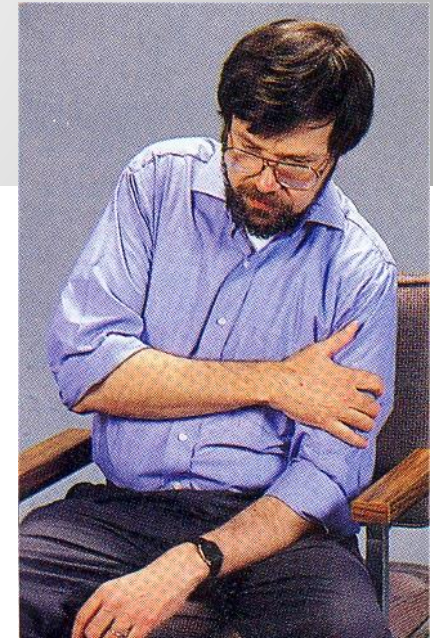
Shoulder

Fingers

Knees

Wrist(fractures)

Elbow(fractures)

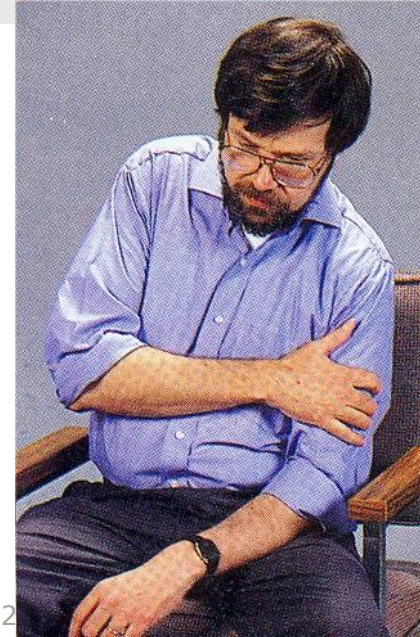


Dislocation

Sign & symptoms



Swelling.
Deformed look.
Pain & tenderness.



Do

1-Check

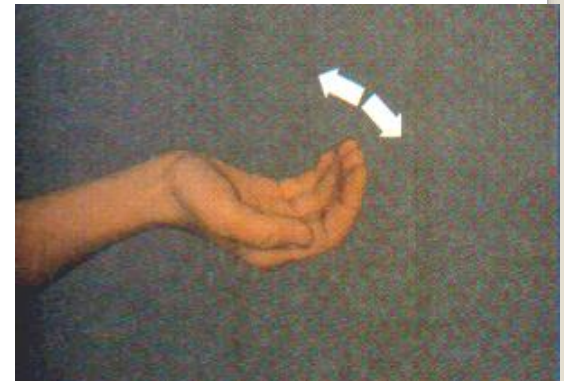
Circulation



Sensation



Movement



2. Use a splint to stabilize the joint position in which it was found.
3. Seek medical attention for reduction of dislocation.
4. Make the victim sit in the most comfortable position for him .



Do not

- **Try to make reduction of dislocation.**





Left index finger dislocation



Anyone experiencing a joint dislocation or subluxation should seek medical assistance as soon as possible.

A dislocated joint can only be successfully 'reduced' into its normal position by a trained medical professional.



Trying to reduce a joint without any training could result in making the injury substantially worse even could result in paralysis



X-rays are usually taken to confirm a diagnosis and detect any fractures which may also have occurred at the time of dislocation. Once a diagnosis is confirmed, the joint is usually manipulated back into position.

This can be a very painful process, therefore this is typically done either in A&E under sedation or in an Operating Room under a General anaesthesia

- It is important the joint is reduced as soon as possible, as in the state of dislocation, the blood supply to the joint (or distal anatomy) may be compromised. This is especially true in the case of a dislocated ankle, due to the anatomy of the blood supply to the foot.
- Shoulder injuries can also be surgically stabilized, depending on the severity, using arthroscopic surgery.

- Some joints are more at risk of becoming dislocated again after an initial injury. This is due to the weakening of the muscles and ligaments which hold the joint in place.
- Shoulders a prime example of this. Any shoulder dislocation should be followed up with thorough physiotherapy

- After care

After a dislocation, injured joints are usually held in place by a splint (for straight joints like fingers and toes) or a bandage (for complex joints like shoulders). Additionally, the joint muscles, tendons and ligaments must also be strengthened.

This is usually done through a course of physiotherapy, which will also help reduce the chances of repeated dislocations of the same joint.



Fracture Vs dislocation

	Fracture	Dislocation
Site	Bone	Joint
Movement	Present but not normal	Absent
Sound	Cracking sound of the fractured bone	No Cracking sound
Sensation	Feel sharp ending of the broken bone	Feel smooth ending of joint bone



Fracture

**Simple
Closed
Fracture**



**Opened
Fracture**

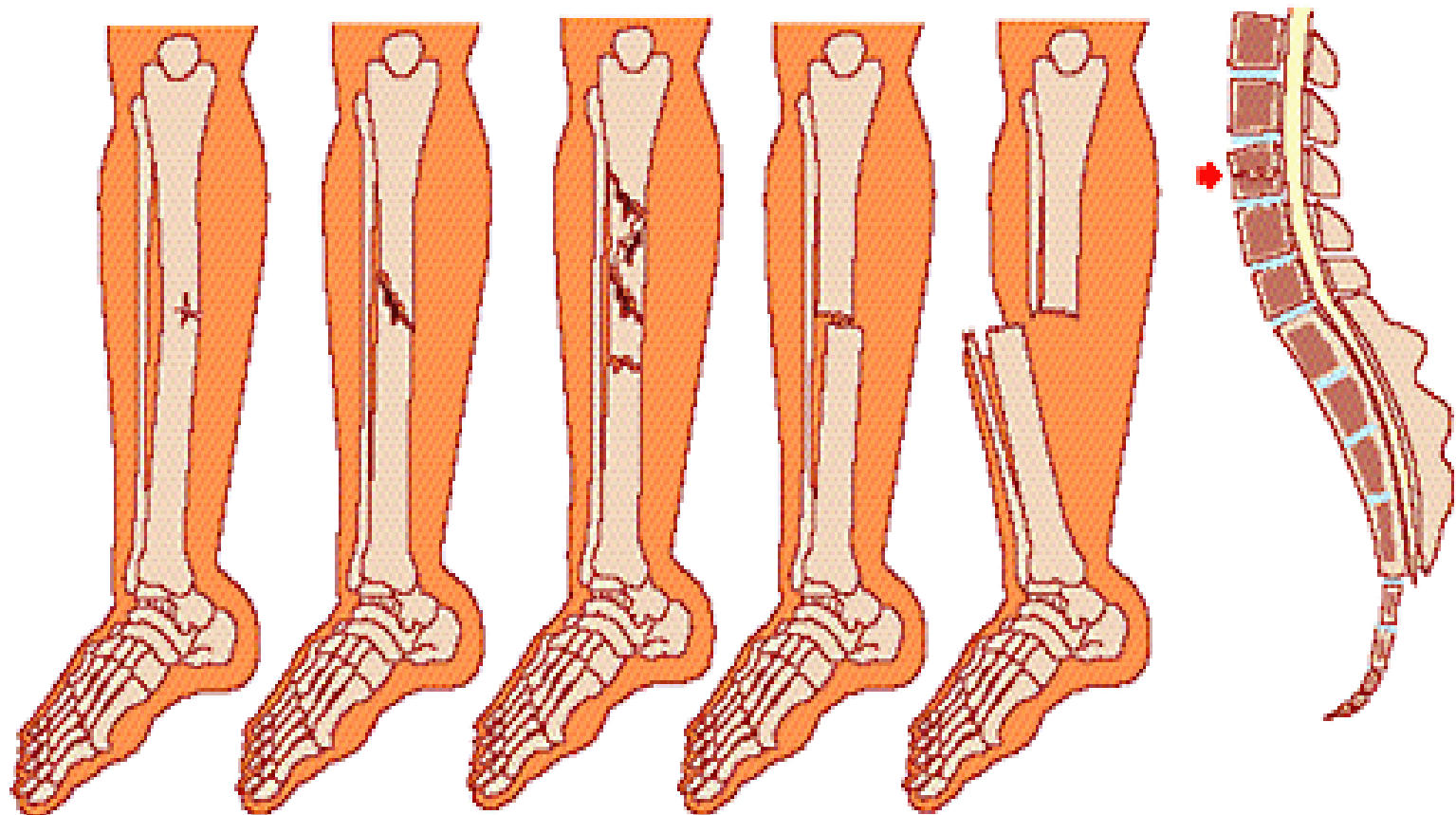


**Spiral
Fracture**



**Compound
Fracture**





Greenstick Spiral Comminuted Transverse Compound Compression

TYPICAL BONE FRACTURES

At Bonwell

Closed fractures :
are those in which the skin is intact, while
Simple fractures:
are fractures that only occur along one
line.

Open Fracture:

A fracture when the bone is in contact with air either by piercing the skin or by severe tissue injury.

•**Complete Fracture-** A fracture in which bone fragments separate completely.

•**Incomplete Fracture-** A fracture in which the bone fragments are still partially joined.

•**Green Stick Fracture-** in which bone are bend it occurs only in infants and young children

•**Incomplete Fracture-** A fracture in which the bone fragments are still partially joined.

•**Spiral Fracture-** A fracture where at least one part of the bone has been twisted.

Sign & symptoms

➤ Deformity

➤ Swelling

➤ Pain and ↑ on touch

➤ Loss of movement

➤ Cracking sound of the fractured bone



Do

- Wash hand and protect yourself
- Remove clothes over the part without moving
- Observe signs of fracture



Check

Circulation



Sensation



Movement



➤ Cover wound if present with sterile or clean dressing

➤ Put ice on the part

➤ Splint the part

➤ Elevate the part in peripheral limb fracture

➤ Call for help



Shoulder



Upper arm

Elbow (straight)



Elbow (bent)

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Do not

➤ Try to reposition the fractured bone

➤ Move the fractured part

- Massage or rub the affected muscle. This will cause more pain only.

Do

1-Check

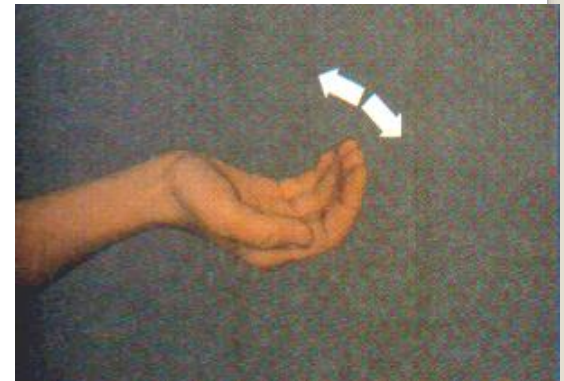
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Sensation



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Thigh

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Knee straight





Knee bent

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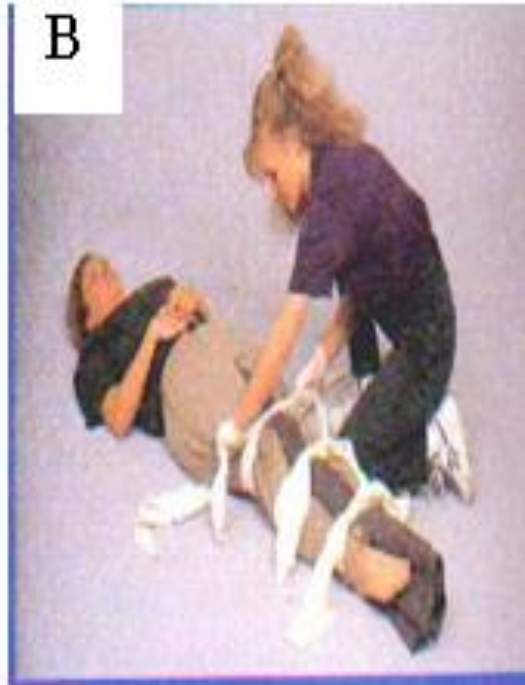
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Leg



Foot and ankle



Support the body by it self

- Use a splint to stabilize the joint position in which it was found

- Seek medical attention for reduction of dislocation.

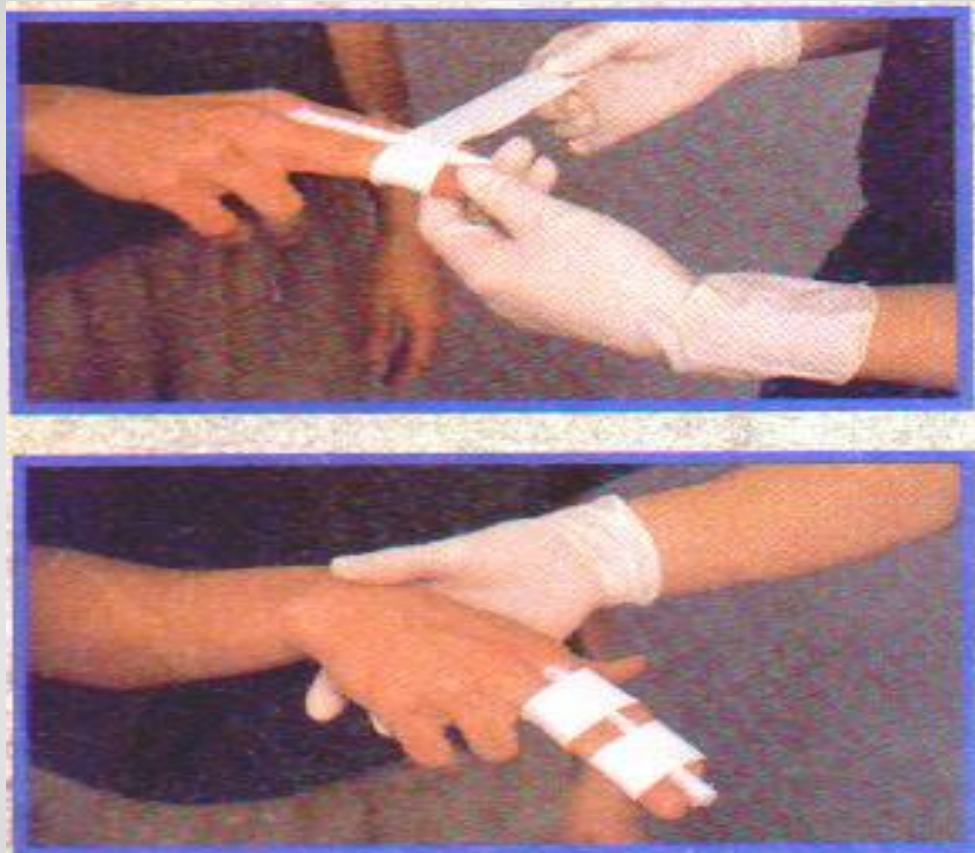
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Forearm



Wrist



Finger